DRILL 20

FIREFIGHTER SURVIVAL

NFPA 1001 Level 2 (JPR 5.3.1, 5.3.3) / WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191

MAYDAY TRANSMISSION & FIREFIGHTER SELF-RESCUE

⏱ **Time:** 45–60 min | 🚒 **Apparatus:** Any Engine/Rescue | 🦺 **PPE:** Full Structural Turnout Gear & SCBA

👥 **Roles:** Drill Leader (Facilitator) | Safety Officer (Watcher) | Firefighter Pairs

🎯 OBJECTIVE & RURAL FIREGROUND VALUE

Every firefighter must be able to recognize a personal fireground emergency, transmit a crisp **MAYDAY** declaration over the radio using the **LUNAR** format, silence their PASS device during transmissions, follow the **GRAB LIVES** survival checklist, and execute a **Reduced Profile SCBA Maneuver** to escape through 16-inch on-center wall studs.

📦 TOOLS & APPARATUS SETUP

- Full SCBA on air for all participants.
- Portable radios on training channel.
- Wall stud prop: 2x4 studs spaced 16 inches on-center (or between two ladders).
- Entanglement prop (simulated wire box: slack wire cables, BX wire, Romex strung in a frame).

⚠️ SAFETY WATCH-OUTS & STOP RULE

⚠️ **Mask Seal Integrity:** During the reduced profile maneuver, watch that facepieces are not twisted, dislodged, or pulled off by wall studs or wire snags.

⚠️ **Panic Management:** If a member becomes stuck in the entanglement prop, do not let them flail. Coach them to breathe calmly.

🛑 **THE STOP RULE: Shout "STOP!" immediately if an SCBA regulator uncouples or if a member experiences true airway compromise.**

PHASE 1: CALLING THE MAYDAY & THE LUNAR REPORT (15 MINUTES) — SLOW DRY RUN

1. **When to Call a Mayday:**
   - Lost, disoriented, or separated from your crew.
   - Trapped by structural collapse or tangled in wiring.
   - SCBA failure, out of air, or low-air alarm sounding without an exit found.
   - Fall through floor or roof.
2. **The Transmission Protocol:**
   - Depress radio PTT button: *"MAYDAY, MAYDAY, MAYDAY! Engine 1 Interior with a Mayday!"*
   - Await IC acknowledgment: *"Command copies Mayday, go with your Mayday."*
   - Deliver the **LUNAR** report:
   - **L – Location:** *"Division 2, Side Bravo, rear bedroom."*
   - **U – Unit:** *"Engine 1 Attack Team."*
   - **N – Name:** *"Firefighter Smith."*
   - **A – Air / Assignment:** *"Search team, 1,200 PSI remaining."*
   - **R – Resources Needed:** *"Ceiling collapse, pinned under joists, need RIT and irons."*

DRILL 20: PRACTICAL EVOLUTIONS & TAILGATE DEBRIEF

Firefighter Survival • Practical Application

PHASE 2: THE GRAB LIVES SURVIVAL ACTIONS (15 MINUTES) — BUDDY COACHING

- **G – Gauge:** Check cylinder pressure.
- **R – Radio:** Call Mayday (LUNAR).
- **A – Activate PASS:** Turn on PASS device manually.
- **B – Breathing:** Drop to skip/box breathing to conserve air.
- **L – Low:** Stay on the floor where air is coolest.
- **I – Illuminate:** Point flashlight beam straight up toward the ceiling.
- **V – Volume:** Bang a hand tool against the floor/wall rhythmically (3 taps).
- **E – Exit Search:** Crawl along walls or follow hose line ("Smooth bump-bump to the pump").
- **S – Shield Airway:** Protect regulator and facepiece from heat.

PHASE 3: THE REDUCED PROFILE MANEUVER (16" STUDS) (20 MINUTES) — TIMED / STRESS

1. Interior firefighter trapped in a room with no exit except an interior partition wall.
2. Breach drywall with Halligan or axe between two 16" studs; clear sheetrock from both sides.
3. Loosen your **right shoulder strap** on the SCBA harness completely.
4. Unbuckle your **waist belt** and **chest strap**.
5. Slip your right arm out of the harness strap. Swing the SCBA pack off your back, holding the left shoulder strap firmly with your left hand.
6. Push the SCBA cylinder through the 16" studs ahead of you (or hold it along your left ribcage).
7. Turn your body sideways, duck your head through, and slide through the studs like a swimmer.
8. Once clear, slip right arm back in, tighten shoulder strap and waist belt, and verify facepiece seal!

⚠️ COMMON PITFALLS & FIREGROUND HAZARDS

- ❌ *Waiting too long to call Mayday:* Waiting until your low-air bell rings before calling Mayday gives the RIT team only 2–3 minutes to reach you. Call early!
- ❌ *Screaming over your PASS alarm:* The PASS alarm must be temporarily silenced while pressing the PTT button to transmit LUNAR, then re-activated immediately.
- ❌ *Disconnecting regulator from facepiece:* Never remove your regulator inside a toxic atmosphere, even if air is running low!

🗣️ 5-MINUTE TAILGATE DEBRIEF

1. ***"How long did it take to deliver the LUNAR report under stress?", "Did anyone snag their regulator hose during the stud crawl?"***

✅ APPARATUS RESET CHECKLIST

- ☐ SCBA harnesses inspected for torn stitching or bent buckles.
- ☐ PASS devices reset and switched off.
- ☐ Cylinders refilled to 4,500 PSI.
- ☐ Attendance roster signed.

DRILL LEADER SIGNATURE	SAFETY OFFICER SIGNATURE	DATE COMPLETED	TRAINING HOURS